

Simtec Consult Ltd - Customer Data and Security Overview

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About This Document

This overview explains the general measures Simtec Consult Ltd uses to protect customer data when delivering software development and IT consultancy services.

It is an assurance summary, not a contract or a guarantee that every listed system is used for every customer. The relevant contract, data processing agreement, and service processing schedule define the actual processing, hosting, retention, recovery, and notification commitments for each customer.

If a customer needs different or additional terms for application data that Simtec is building, hosting, supporting, or accessing, these can be discussed and negotiated during project discovery, contracting, or controlled project change. This may include data residency, approved suppliers, access, encryption, environment separation, retention, deletion, backups, recovery targets, security testing, incident notification, or AI-tool restrictions. A requirement becomes binding only when the parties record and agree it in the contract, statement of work, data processing schedule, or change record.

Company And Certification

Simtec Consult Ltd is a small UK-based software development and IT consultancy. The whole organisation is certified to Cyber Essentials.

- Certificate ID: 34f01667-07cb-49b5-a593-b9fac1be082a
- Certified on: 17 June 2026
- Valid to: 17 June 2027
- Certification body: URM
- Scheme issuer: The IASME Consortium Ltd

Cyber Essentials supports Simtec's baseline technical security controls. It does not replace service-specific contractual, privacy, resilience, or application-security commitments.

Our Data Protection Role

Simtec may act in different roles depending on the work:

- as a processor when handling personal data on a customer's documented instructions; or
- as a controller for Simtec's own business administration, customer contacts, contracts, billing, recruitment, and legal obligations.

The applicable role, purposes, data categories, people affected, and duration must be recorded in the service processing schedule.

The applicable contract, statement of work, privacy information, or accompanying customer communication provides the data protection contact for the engagement.

Where Customer Data Is Stored

Customer data is stored only in approved systems needed for the relevant service. Depending on the engagement, these may include:

- customer-controlled systems;
- cloud infrastructure managed by Simtec for customer applications;
- managed database and object or file storage used by those applications;
- approved source control and deployment services;
- approved business communication and document services; and
- approved project, support, security, logging, or monitoring services.

Where Simtec hosts a customer application, its application data, database records, uploaded files, generated files, logs, and supporting configuration may be held in Simtec-managed cloud infrastructure. Simtec uses that data only to provide, secure, support, recover, and maintain the agreed service, or to meet documented legal or contractual obligations.

Primary customer application data, including database records and application files, is hosted in UK or EEA regions unless a different location is agreed with the customer in writing. Some approved suppliers may process account, support, security, traffic, or service metadata elsewhere using applicable data protection and international transfer safeguards.

Access is limited to authorised people and services with a project or operational need. Application data and files remain subject to the agreed access, retention, backup, return, and deletion arrangements throughout the service and when it ends.

Staff should avoid storing customer data locally unless there is a clear business need and must remove local copies when they are no longer required.

This overview deliberately uses provider-neutral descriptions so it remains accurate when supported infrastructure changes. The current applicable suppliers are recorded in the customer subprocessor information. Any customer requirement for a particular provider, location, architecture, or restriction must be agreed in the service processing schedule or contract before it becomes a commitment.

Access Control

Simtec's general access controls include:

- named user and administrator accounts;
- access limited by role, project, and business need;
- Director approval for administrator access;
- multi-factor authentication for cloud service users and administrators where available;
- separate use of local administrator credentials for administrative tasks;
- prompt removal of accounts, sessions, tokens, keys, and access when no longer required; and
- periodic and change-triggered access reviews.

Customer-provided systems remain subject to the customer's access instructions and technical controls unless these conflict with legal or security obligations.

Devices And Remote Working

Simtec works remotely and permits approved bring-your-own-device working. Devices used for company work must use supported operating systems, security updates, screen locks, firewalls, malware protection or trusted

application-source controls, and separate administrator use where needed.

Customer-specific restrictions on local storage, device encryption, remote wipe, disposal, or use of customer-managed devices can be agreed in the contract or service processing schedule. Simtec must not claim that a control applies unless it is implemented and recorded for the service.

Encryption And Secrets

Simtec requires secure transport and at-rest protection where provided and appropriate to the selected service. Credentials, API keys, tokens, SSH keys, private keys, and deployment secrets must be kept out of source control and stored in approved password, secret, or environment-management tooling.

The service processing schedule must confirm the actual encryption controls for production data, backups, logs, repositories, staff devices, and administrative access. Simtec will not claim that all customer data is encrypted at rest until this has been verified for the relevant service.

Secure Software Development

Software projects use proportionate security controls based on project risk and customer requirements. These may include:

- security consideration during design;
- named source-control accounts, MFA where available, and project-based repository access;
- code or change review;
- separation and protection of development, staging, and production secrets;
- supported dependencies from trusted sources;
- dependency, configuration, permission, exposed-port, and sensitive-workflow review;
- controlled build and deployment access; and
- communication of security-relevant releases, remediation steps, and end-of-support warnings.

The statement of work or service schedule should identify mandatory testing, review, vulnerability remediation, and production-data restrictions for the particular project.

Customer-specific development and application-data requirements should be agreed early enough to influence architecture, supplier selection, delivery time, and cost. Later requirements may be handled through the agreed change-control process.

Suppliers And Subprocessors

New suppliers and cloud services require Director approval before use for Simtec or customer data. Reviews consider the data involved, access controls, MFA, security responsibilities, backup and export options, data location, international transfers, contract terms, exit, and deletion.

Only suppliers that process personal data for the relevant customer service should be listed as that customer's subprocessors. Applicable subprocessors, locations, transfer arrangements, and change-notification terms must be recorded in the customer agreement or service schedule.

International Transfers

The service processing schedule must state whether personal data is transferred or made accessible outside the UK. Where applicable, it must identify the relevant destination, UK adequacy coverage, contractual safeguard, and any required transfer risk assessment or data protection test.

Simtec must complete and retain the relevant supplier and transfer review before making a customer-facing transfer commitment.

Retention, Return And Deletion

Customer data must not be kept longer than needed for the agreed service, legal obligations, dispute handling, security, support, or another documented purpose. When it is no longer needed, Simtec must return, delete, or anonymise it as appropriate to the system and customer instructions.

The service processing schedule must define:

- active-service retention;
- retention after contract termination;
- application database, file, repository, ticket, communication, export, and log retention;
- deletion from primary systems;
- backup expiry or deletion; and
- any legally required exceptions.

Backup And Recovery

Backups or equivalent recovery methods are considered for customer application data hosted by Simtec, source code, deployment and infrastructure configuration, and other material systems. Recovery arrangements are protected from unauthorised access and reviewed or tested at least annually and after material changes.

The relevant service schedule must state the verified backup frequency, retention, separation, encryption, recovery point objective, recovery time objective, restore-test approach, and any exclusions. No recovery target applies unless it is agreed for the particular service.

Security Incidents And Personal Data Breaches

Simtec maintains an incident response and personal data breach process covering reporting, triage, containment, investigation, recovery, notification decisions, and lessons learned.

Where Simtec processes personal data for a customer, it will notify the customer without undue delay after becoming aware of a personal data breach affecting that data and will provide reasonable information and cooperation to help the customer meet its obligations.

The contract or service schedule should identify the notification contact, any agreed initial-notification target, the information to be supplied as it becomes available, and update expectations.

The applicable contract, statement of work, or accompanying customer communication provides the monitored security incident contact for the engagement.

AI Tools

Staff and contractors must not enter confidential customer data, personal data, secrets, production data, or commercially sensitive information into AI tools unless the Director has approved the tool and use case and the relevant confidentiality, supplier, data protection, and customer requirements have been addressed.

Any customer-specific restriction on AI-assisted work must be recorded in the contract or statement of work.

Customer Requests

Customers may request the applicable processing schedule, subprocessor list, Cyber Essentials certificate details, or proportionate supporting information.

Customers should raise application-specific data handling or security requirements during project discovery or as soon as they arise. Simtec will assess feasibility, risk, supplier limitations, delivery impact, and cost before the parties agree the requirement in writing.

The applicable proposal, contract, statement of work, or accompanying customer communication provides the assurance contact for the engagement.

Change Control

Customer-specific commitments are controlled by the relevant contract, statement of work, processing schedule, or agreed change record.